PROactive PRONUNCIATION

# “AH” /a/ Vs. “OH” /o/ Minimal Pairs

People often pronounce the “AH”/a/ with rounded lips, similar to “OH”/o/. So, the word “not” with the /a/ sound will sound more like “note” with the /o/ sound. A word like “raw” will sound like “row” with the /o/ sound. The “AH”/a/ on the other hand, requires that we use a relaxed lip position.

## /a/ vs. /o/

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| on | own | off | oaf |
| not | note | calm | comb |
| rob | robe | walk | woke |
| rod | road | chalk | choke |
| rot | wrote | odd | ode |
| mop | mope | opera | Oprah |
| top | taupe | pause | pose |
| sod | sewed | taught | tote |
| hop | hope | | |